A-A-50880A
30 May 1989
SUPERSEDING
A-A-50880
June 7, 1983

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

TUBING, STERILIZATION

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description as a replacement for Federal Specification L-T-1313 which is cancelled.

This Commercial Item Description covers nylon, transparent, lay-flat tubing suitable for fabrication as a container for items to be sterilized by steam sterilization after closing, and to maintain sterility after autoclaving.

Salient characteristics:

The sterilization tubing shall be transparent, lay-flat, nylon film tubing made from virgin, non-plasticized, first grade resin, type 6 suitable for use in steam autoclaves to 136°C (277°F) at 30 pounds per square inch and to 20 inches of vacuum. The tubing shall be supplied in the sizes specified below. All sizes shall be 500 feet in length, wound on a suitable reel, with a tolerance of plus or minus 1/2 inch for all widths except for the 2 inch size which shall be plus or minus 1/4 inch.

Size I	6 inches wide flat
Size II	12 inches wide flat
Size III	18 inches wide flat
Size IV	2 inches wide flat
Size V	4 inches wide flat
Size VI	8 inches wide flat

The tubing shall be suitable for use in packaging medical supplies for steam autoclaving and shall maintain sterility after sterilization. Excess air shall be removed before the package is sealed, or closed with auto-clavable tape, to insure no problems occur during sterilization.

AMSC N/A FSC 6530

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The tubing shall have an average thickness between 0.0018 inch and 0.0022 inch, with a minimum thickness, at any one point, of 0.0014 inch for the 2 inch wide tubing and 0.0015 inch for all other widths. The tubing shall have a minimum tensile strength of 8000 pounds per square inch. The tubing shall be capable of being heat-sealed at 425°F plus or minus 25°F and a pressure of 35 plus or minus 5 pounds per square inch, or being closed with auto-clavable tape.

The tubing shall be furnished wound firmly on a paperboard core in a suitable, easy-to-use, dispenser type container. The tubing shall be free of pinholes, wrinkles, blisters, streaks, and crow-feet, dirt and foreign matter. Any one roll of tubing shall contain no more than one break in continuity. The paperboard core shall not extend more than 1/4 inch beyond roll at either end.

Workmanship. The sterilization tubing shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Roll (RO). One roll containing five hundred feet of tubing, of the size specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

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Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 1.0 (percent defective) and an inspection level of II. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one roll of sterilization tubing as specified in this description.

Defects.

Tubing is not nylon, with the resin as specified.

Tubing is not free of pinholes.

Tubing is not free from wrinkles.

Tubing is not free from streaks, crow-feet, or blisters.

Tubing is not firmly and evenly rolled on core.

Roll is not free from more than one break in continuity.

Finished roll is not round.

Paperboard core extends more than 1/4 inch beyond roll at either end.

Tubing is not free from dirt or foreign matter.

Tubing does not unroll freely from box.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for test's including dimensional test shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 2.5 (percent defective) and an inspection level of S-3. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one roll of sterilization tubing.

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Tests

Tensile Strength. The sterilization tubing shall be tested for tensile strength in accordance with the ASTM Standard Methods of ASTM D-882. A tensile strength less than 8000 pounds per square inch shall constitute a defect.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

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NOTE: The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document:

6530-00-104-7530	(Size I)
6530-00-104-7531	(Size II)
6530-00-104-7532	(Size III)
6530-00-104-7533	(Size IV)
6530-00-104-7534	(Size V)
6530-00-105-6794	(Size VI)

*The sterilization tubing shall be capable of being heat sealed with a sealer, NSN 3540-00-299-9811.

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling, and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD - MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6530-2019

Location: CID/TUBING/H13-30

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1 DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-5088A	TUBING, STERILIZATION

NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION

4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*

- ☐ VENDOR
- ☐ USER
- ☐ MANUFACTURER
- ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*:

b ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6 REMARKS

7 NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional

8 WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional

c MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional

8 DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

DD FORM 1426

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NOTE This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

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